

ABOUT THE BLOG

IN-DEPTH READS

ONLINE COURSES

Q&amp;A LISTINGS

THE RED UMBRELLA PODCASTS

# The Humble I

Knowing, Doing, Becoming

28

APR 2013

23

Comments

## Seven Rights of the Prophet ﷺ



To travel through any Muslim land is to see tall, graceful towers – minarets – studded across the landscape from which, five times a day, the muezzin punctuates communal life by calling believers to prayer (*salat*). This stark, yet simple call serves to remind the community that in their day to day life – with its joys and its pains, its hopes and its disappointments – there runs a thread leading them to their ultimate purpose and end goal: Allah, and that it is time now – for a short while, at least – to put aside the world and restore to the soul a fuller and more natural awareness of Him. It is a call which helps put life into perspective.

The muezzin starts his call by first extolling Allah's greatness (*takbir, allahu akbar*) and then follows it by proclaiming the Declaration of Faith, or *shahadah*. The first half of this Declaration is to testify to: *la ilaha illa'Llah* –

»

### Follow Blog

Enter your email to follow this blog and receive notifications of new posts by email.

Join 1,203 other subscribers.

Follow

### To Book Me

[aabookings@jawziyyah.com](mailto:aabookings@jawziyyah.com)

### Believer's Path

- [1. Knowing, Doing, Becoming](#)
- [2. Cause of Muslim Weakness](#)
- [3. Doesn't 'Aqidah Comes First?](#)
- [4. Obligatory Spiritual Journey](#)
- [5. Legitimate Islamic Learning](#)

### Key Reading

- [1. Proof for God's Existence](#)
- [2. Jihad, War & Peace](#)
- [3. Seven Right of the Prophet ﷺ](#)
- [4. The 73 Sects Hadith Explained](#)
- [5. Learning Sacred Knowledge](#)
- [6. Does Science Point to God?](#)
- [7. Revisiting Islamic Orthodoxy](#)
- [8. Women, Mosques, Misogyny](#)
- [9. Islam & Perennialism](#)
- [10. Man: Created in God's Image](#)

### Topical Reads

- [1. Terrorism Is Not Jihad](#)
- [2. 'Ulema as Macro Thinkers](#)
- [3. Beware Pseudo-Scholars](#)
- [4. Islam's Earth Ethics](#)
- [5. Khawarij, ISIS & Wahhabism](#)
- [6. Practical Steps to Learn Fiqh](#)

‘There is no god worthy of worship but Allah’. The second half bears witness to: *muhammadun rasulu’Llah* – ‘Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.’ The first half affirms the doctrine of *tawhid*; the second, the method by which to live out and implement this doctrine.

*Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah* obliges on each believer certain rights or *huquq*, all of which have been mentioned in the Qur’an. Scholars explain that these rights are seven in number:



**1. To Believe in Him:** This does not mean to merely believe he was a true, historical figure of seventh century Arabia, but to believe in his prophethood (*nubuwwah*) and in Allah’s message (*risalah*) to him too. The Qur’an says: *Believe, therefore, in Allah and His Messenger, and the light which We have sent down.* [64:8] One hadith says: ‘I have been ordered to fight mankind till they testify that there is no god but Allah and until they believe in me and what I was sent with.’ [Muslim, no.34]



**2. To Obey Him:** It is not enough to believe in him, peace be upon him. Instead, true faith necessitates that we be guided by his message and obey its demands: *O you who believe! Obey Allah and His Messenger, and do not turn away from him when you hear him speak.* [8:20] *He who obeys the Messenger has obeyed Allah.* [4:80] One hadith declares: ‘All my nation will enter Paradise save those who refuse.’ They asked: O Messenger of Allah, who would refuse? He replied: ‘Whoever obeys me will enter Paradise, whoever disobeys me has in fact refused.’ [Al-Bukhari, no.7280]



**3. To Emulate His Example:** Given that Allah says about His beloved Prophet, peace be upon him: *Yours is indeed a tremendous character*, [68:4] it should come as no surprise to enlightened minds that imitation of the Prophet, peace be upon him, is also a right we owe him. The Qur’an states: *Say: “If you love Allah, then follow me.”* [3:31] Elsewhere it tells us: *You have in the Messenger of Allah a beautiful example.* [33:21] One celebrated hadith says: ‘Whoever turns away from my *Sunnah* is not of me.’ [Al-Bukhari, no.5063; Muslim, no.1401]

No doubt, within the overall obligation of *ittiba’* – to “follow” or “emulate” him – there are certain matters where emulation is mandatory, and other places where it is highly encouraged and urged, but not obligated (there are even some matters recorded about his life that are just descriptive, not prescriptive). A sound knowledge of *fiqh* should help distinguish between these levels of imitation and emulation. With that being so, believers try their best to conform to the prophetic example, and mould their lives in the light of his *Sunnah*, as far as possible. For it is in him that the Adamic perfection is found and the beauty of behaviour made manifest.



**4. To Love Him:** We find in the Qur’an: *Say: “If your fathers, your sons, your brothers, your wives, your tribe, the wealth you have gained, the trade you fear my slacken, and the home you delight in are more loved by you than Allah and His Messenger and striving in His cause, then wait till Allah brings about His command. Allah guides not the corrupt.* [9:24] Indeed, love of the Prophet is what distinguishes believers in their perfection of faith, as one hadith says: ‘None

[7. Taqlid, Proofs & Madhhabs](#)  
[8. On Modern Muslimness](#)  
[9. Takfir: Its Dangers & Rules](#)  
[10. Hanbalis & Merry Christmas](#)

## Comments



[omarkn](#) on  
[Contemporary  
 Challenges to Isl...](#)



Surkheel Abu  
 Aaliyah on [Kalam  
 & the Hanbalis: Is...](#)



Junaid on [Kalam &  
 the Hanbalis: Is...](#)



Iqbal khan on  
[Denying the  
 Ahadith  
 Concerning...](#)



Mark Keller on  
[Islam's Evolution  
 Questi...](#)



Surkheel Abu  
 Aaliyah on  
[Knowing Tawhid in  
 Ten Minutes...](#)



Surkheel Abu  
 Aaliyah on [Is  
 Today's Islam a  
 Failure or...](#)

## Categories

[2 minute transformers](#)  
[5 minute meditations \(video\)](#)  
[a short read](#)  
[activism](#)  
[atheism & muslim apologetics](#)  
[consider Islam](#)  
[contemporary concerns](#)  
[correctives & clarifications](#)  
[environment & earth ethics](#)  
[eschatology & the end days](#)  
[ethics & morals](#)  
[fiqh issues & usul al-fiqh](#)  
[footprints on the sands of time](#)  
[hanbali fiqh](#)  
[heart matters](#)  
[history](#)  
[jilani discourses](#)  
[knowledge & epistemology](#)  
[marriage, family, gender](#)  
[marvels of man](#)  
[modernity & muslimness](#)  
[orthodoxy & ahl al-sunnah](#)  
[pillars of religious practice](#)

of you believes until he loves me more than his father, his children and the whole of mankind.’ [Al-Bukhari, no.15; Muslim, no.44]

An essential part of loving the Prophet, peace be upon him, is to love his Family. The Prophet, peace be upon him, once urged: *udhakkirukumū’Llaha fi ahli bayti* – ‘I advise you concerning my family.’ [Muslim, no.2408] Once, Zayd b. Thabit was once praying the funeral prayer for his mother, after which he brought his mule near in order to mount it, upon which Ibn ‘Abbas came and took hold of the stirrup. Zayd said: ‘Let it be, O nephew of Allah’s Messenger.’ Ibn ‘Abbas said: ‘This is how we were taught to treat the scholars.’ So Zayd took hold of Ibn ‘Abbas’ hand and, upon kissing it, said: ‘This is how we were taught to treat the family of our Prophet.’ [Al-Tabarani, *Mu’jam al-Kabir*, no.4746]



**5. To Honour and Revere Him:** True faith (*iman*) not only demands that he be loved, but that he be honoured and revered too. The Qur’an insists: *Those who believe in him, honour him, support him, and follow the light that was sent down with him: those are the successful.* [7:157] *That you may honour him and revere him.* [48:9] Al-Qazwini contrasts honour, reverence and veneration (described by terms such as *tabjil*, *tawqir* and *ta’zim*) with that of love and cites Imam al-Bayhaqi saying: ‘This is a higher degree than that of love; for not all who love revere. A father loves his child, or a master his slave, but does not revere him. Whereas all who revere also love.’<sup>1</sup>



**6. To Believe that Prophethood Ended With Him:** The Qur’an declares: *Muhammad is not the father of any man among you, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the Seal of the Prophets; and Allah has knowledge of all things.* [33:40] Needless to say, when a thing is “sealed”, it is complete and so there can be no further addition to it. In a like manner, the Prophet Muhammad sealed the cycle of prophethood and brought it to a close: he is the last Prophet, after whom there will be no prophet. Henceforth, revealed truths shall be revived and reanimated by scholars, saints and renewers; but never again by prophets. That our Prophet, upon whom be peace, is *khatim al-nabiyyin* – “the Seal of the Prophets” – is also confirmed in many hadiths; one of which says: ‘There will arise among my nation thirty liars, all of them claiming to be a prophet. But I am the final Prophet; there will be no prophet after me.’ [Muslim, no.2889; Abu Dawud, no.4252]



**7. To Send Blessings (Salat) and Salutations of Peace (Salam) Upon Him:** When telling us that Allah and His angels are constantly raising the rank, status and honour of the Prophet, peace be upon him, the Qur’an states the following: *Allah and His angels send blessings upon the Prophet. O you who believe! Send blessings upon him and salute him with a worthy salutation.* [33:56] The hadith literature records: ‘Whosoever invokes one blessing upon me, Allah will send ten blessings on him.’ [Muslim, no.384] And: ‘Those closest to me on the Day of Resurrection are those who invoke most blessings upon me.’ [Al-Tirmidhi, no.484] And: ‘The miser is he who, whenever I am mentioned in his presence, does not invoke blessings upon me.’ [Al-Tirmidhi, no.3546]

As for what it means for Allah to “bless” or “send *salat*” on the Prophet, Abu’l-‘Aliyah, a famous *tabi’i*, explained: ‘Allah’s *salat* is His extolling him to the angels; the angels’ *salat* is their supplication [for him].’<sup>2</sup> The majoritarian view seems to be the one al-Tirmidhi records: ‘It is related from Sufyan al-Thawri and others from the people of knowledge that *salât* of the Lord is His mercy, and *salat* of the

[podcast](#)  
[poetry, limericks, literature](#)  
[politics & society](#)  
[prophetology](#)  
[psychology & mental health](#)  
[qur'an, tafsir, tadabbur](#)  
[ramadan & fasting](#)  
[reason, religion, rationality](#)  
[religion](#)  
[salafism reconsidered](#)  
[science & religion](#)  
[short texts for reflection](#)  
[sirah & sacred history](#)  
[sufism, suluk & spirituality](#)  
[technology & social change](#)  
[theology](#)  
[visual qur'an reflections](#)  
[wealth & trade](#)

## Video

00:00

12:06

## Twitter



angels is their seeking forgiveness for him.’<sup>3</sup>

Hence Allah blesses the Prophet by the constant effusion of mercy descending upon him; such divine mercy referring to: light, knowledge, revelation, support, protection, swift response to prayers, exalting in rank and nearness to Him, honourable mention of him, as well as other things that only Allah and His Beloved know. The angels bless the Prophet by praying for him and supporting him. The believers, by invoking Allah’s blessings upon him. As for salutations (*salam*), it is praying for protection, safety and peace upon him.



In conclusion: May Allah send blessings and peace upon our Prophet whenever his name is mentioned by those who may remember him, or neglected by those who are heedless of him. May Allah bless him among the first and the last of generations with the most favourable, most abundant and purest blessings that He has bestowed upon any of His creation. For, as the venerable Imam al-Shafi’i has written, ‘no blessing, be it seen or unseen, has ever descended on us by which we gained spiritual or temporal gain, or by which spiritual or temporal harm was repelled, except that Muhammad, upon whom be peace, was the reason for it; the leader to its goodness; director to its guidance; protector from its destruction and evil that oppose righteousness; warner against what brings ruin; ever ready with sincere advice for guidance and warning. So may Allah’s blessings be upon him and his family, as His blessings are upon Abraham and his family. Indeed You [Allah] are Praiseworthy, Majestic.’<sup>4</sup>



1. *Mukhtasar Shu‘ab al-Iman* (Cairo: Maktabah al-Turath al-Islami, n.d.), 29.
2. Related by al-Bukhari as a Chapter Heading (*bab*) to hadith no.4797.
3. Al-Tirmidhi, as a gloss to hadith no.485.
4. *Al-Risalah* (Beirut: Dar al-Kutub al-‘Ilmiyyah, n.d.), 16-17.

Posted in [prophetology](#) and tagged [meaning of salat on the Prophet](#), [Muhammad the final prophet](#), [Prophet Muhammad in the eyes of the Muslims](#), [rights of the Prophet](#), [seal of the prophets](#), [the final prophet](#), [The seven rights of the Prophet Muhammad](#), [veneration of the Prophet](#)

[← Older Entry](#)

[Newer Entry →](#)

## 23 thoughts on “Seven Rights of the Prophet ﷺ”



nazeer ahmed on [April 29, 2013 at 4:29 pm](#) said:  
what a beautiful article.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



[Abu Aaliyah](#) on [May 1, 2013 at 10:12 am](#) said:  
*Mashallah*. Whatever beauty is present in the article, is due to the profound beauty of the one being written about, *sallallahu ‘alayhi wa sallam*.

## Tweets by [@Abu\\_Aaliyah](#)



**Surkheel Abu Aaliyah**  
[@Abu\\_Aaliyah](#)

"What You Can and Cannot Do With Scientific Proofs":  
[t.me/thejawziyyah/1...](https://t.me/thejawziyyah/1...)



Jun 13, 2022

Surkheel Abu Aaliyah  
Retweeted



**Cambridge Muslim College**  
[@CMC\\_Cambridge](#)

Marking the end of [#BuildingAnArk](#), Sh Abdal Hakim provided some reflections at our Eid Garden Party on intuiting the miracle of living things around us so that we can recognise what it means for us to become living things. [#faithinscholarship](#)  
Watch now - [youtu.be/GbyBx-uivSw](https://youtu.be/GbyBx-uivSw)



Jun 9, 2022

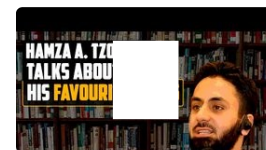
Surkheel Abu Aaliyah  
Retweeted



**Paul Williams**  
[@freemonotheist](#)

Hamza A. Tzortzis Talks About His Favourite Books  
[youtu.be/Es0cc4xDk5k](https://youtu.be/Es0cc4xDk5k) via [@YouTube](#)

[YouTube](#) [@YouTube](#)



Jun 9, 2022

[Embed](#)

[View on Twitter](#)

May Allah bless you.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



Ugly boyz on [December 3, 2017 at 12:51 am](#) said:  
Boi u all ugly hahah

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



Akbar on [May 13, 2019 at 6:20 am](#) said:  
Question :

If Mohammad is the seal of the prophet and the last and final messenger for humanity... Then it means that Allah is henceforth unable to send any more messages to mankind for eternity since Mohammad has now died.

It feels like Allah revelations has an expiry date and was limited to Mohammed and now he is powerless to communicate any further advise to modern man. Please clarify how to counter this objection.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)

## [Facebook](#)

## Archives

Select Month ▼

## Blogroll

[A Common Word](#)  
[Cambridge Khutbas etc.](#)  
[Cambridge Muslim College](#)  
[Forgotten Women](#)  
[Global Issues](#)  
[Islamic Courses](#)  
[Islamic Spirituality](#)  
[Jawziyyah Institute](#)  
[Musa's Muftic Musings](#)  
[Muslim Matters](#)  
[National Zakat Foundation](#)  
[New Crescent Society](#)  
[New Islamic Directions](#)  
[SeemeeHearMe](#)  
[Yahya Birt](#)

## Blog Stats

964,240 hits



Abu Aaliyah on [May 21, 2019 at 1:25 pm](#) said:

The simple answer to your question, Akbar, is that Allah's revelation to the Prophet, peace be upon him, doesn't have an expiry date, because it is universal and meant to be for all ages, peoples and places.

The teachings with which the Prophet, peace be upon him, came have a spiritual and social technology built in to it that makes it relevant, applicable and liveable even today, in the 21st century world. Otherwise, how do we explain the phenomena of the hundreds of millions of Muslims across the world who are practically able to live out the religious teachings of Islam, draw spiritual nourishment from its teachings, and are still engaged in the modern world. Indeed, look how Islam continues to thrive and flourishes in those Western lands which are considered to be the beating heart of the modern world.

Other religious traditions have had to either buckle under pressure and reform in a way that would be totally unrecognisable to its founder, or compromise its core beliefs and practices, or simply bow to the mighty of modernity and get absorbed into its worldview. But, and all praise is for Allah, that is not what has happened to Islam. Its truths and teachings are still practical and liveable and its timeless truths – despite political propaganda, media bias, and Muslim folly – still attract people to its fold and teachings every single day! It still has the power to speak to modern man, and his deepest needs and aspirations!

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



[shakeel](#) on [April 30, 2013 at 11:05 am](#) said:

Reading this reminder has increased me in humility and love for the best of creation!

Jazak'Allah Khair!

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



[Abu Aaliyah](#) on [May 1, 2013 at 10:14 am](#) said:

May Allah increase us all in such matters. *Barakallahu fikum.*

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



[syed](#) on [April 30, 2013 at 3:59 pm](#) said:

JazakAllahu khair for the reminder....

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



[Abu Aaliyah](#) on [May 1, 2013 at 10:15 am](#) said:  
Barakallahu fikum Syed.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



Rehan on [May 1, 2013 at 7:38 pm](#) said:  
Masha Allah very good article , may Allah reward you for that.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



[Abu Aaliyah](#) on [May 8, 2013 at 11:10 am](#) said:  
May Allah reward you too, Rehan.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



Syed Abdul Basit Gillani on [May 5, 2013 at 1:08 am](#) said:  
Jazakomullah Khair Sheikh,  
Let us Send Blessings (Salat) and Salutations of Peace (Salam) Upon  
Him.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



[Abu Aaliyah](#) on [May 8, 2013 at 11:11 am](#) said:  
Barakallahu fikum – sallallahu ‘ala Muhammad, sallallahu  
‘alayhi wa sallam.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



Abu Hamza on [May 8, 2013 at 11:02 am](#) said:  
Mashallah – what a beautiful reminder of the rights of the most  
righteous of men (saw)! Jazakallah for this piece.

I was wondering if I may ask you Ustadh about the dua after adhaan which implores Allah swt to give Muhammad (saw) the rank that he was promised. I never quite got my head around the concept of asking Allah (swt) to live up to His promise as He surely will – right? Is this dua indirectly a rhetorical way of sending blessings upon Rasool (saw)? Are there other examples of this type of wording in the Sunnah?

Ws

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



[Abu Aaliyah](#) on [February 18, 2015 at 1:29 pm](#) said:  
Sorry for the delay Abu Hamza. I'm out of the country at the moment, but will endeavour to answer the question when I get back k to the UK.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)[mahammasood](#) on [February 9, 2015 at 8:22 am](#) said:

This is beautiful. Sallallaahu walayhee wasallam.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)[Abu Aaliyah](#) on [February 18, 2015 at 1:35 pm](#) said:

Writing about the paragon of human beauty so easily lends itself to the actual writing reflecting even a little of such immense beauty. May Allah shower His beloved with the choicest blessings of peace that has ever been bestowed on any of the creation.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)[Mehdi Hasan Sheikh](#) on [August 25, 2015 at 4:18 am](#) said:

Rights\*

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)[Abu Aaliyah](#) on [August 25, 2015 at 2:34 pm](#) said:

Jazakallahu khayran for the correction. It could only be a 'mehdi' who brings about correction in terms of the prophetic rights.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)['Uthmān](#) on [May 5, 2016 at 11:50 am](#) said:

As-salaamu `alaykum wa rahmatullaahi wa barakaatuhu,

Thank you for a helpful and informative blog post. I wish to enquire further about what it means for Allah to send Salah and Salaam upon the Prophet (sallAllahu `alayhi wa sallam) so that I can understand and mean what I'm saying when I ask Allah to do so.

To quote:

"Hence Allah blesses the Prophet by the constant effusion of mercy descending upon him; such divine mercy referring to: light, knowledge, revelation, support, protection, swift response to prayers, exalting in rank and nearness to Him, honourable mention of him, as well as other things that only Allah and His Beloved know."

I find this difficult to understand. What kind of light, and how will it benefit him (sallAllahu `alayhi wa sallam)? Of what knowledge, revelation, support, protection and swift response to prayers is the Prophet (sallAllahu `alayhi wa sallam) in need or would he benefit from at this point in time? What exactly is meant by exalting in rank and nearness to Him (subhaanahu wa ta`aala)? And what exactly is meant by honourable mention, in what context does it occur and what are the consequences of it?

Regarding salaam, you wrote: "As for salutations (salam), it is praying for protection, safety and peace upon him."



Again: From what could the Prophet (sallAllahu `alayhi wa sallam) benefit from protection and safety? And is he (sallAllahu `alayhi wa sallam) in any danger of not experiencing peace? And while we're at it, what actually is the nature and reality of his present existence (sallAllahu `alayhi wa sallam)?

I would appreciate some help here!

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



**Abu Aaliyah** on [May 15, 2016 at 12:48 pm](#) said:

*Wa alaykum al-salam wa rahmatullahi wa barakatuhu.*

Thank you for your question. In truth, there really isn't much more I can add to what is already written. So this brief response may not quite remove the mists of confusion you we're hoping for. That said:

Some of the manifestations of Allah's blessings upon His *khalil* and *habib* ﷺ occurred and concluded in this world; other continue in the barazkh and the Hereafter.

His honourable mention [by those angels closest to Allah]; his exaltation in rank [by him having a continuous reward for every person who acts upon any guidance or *Sunnah* he was sent with, for instance]; and him increasing in knowing Allah, all continue even after his passing away from this world ﷺ.

As for the reality of light, closeness and other such matters, none knows the exact nature of them, except Allah and His Beloved.

Qadi 'Iyyad's *al-Shifa* (an English translation of it exists) is generally considered to be the epitome of this area of knowledge. It is well worth referring to.

*Wa'Llahu'l-hadi ila'l-sawa al-sabil.*

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



**Mehdi H Sheikh** on [December 11, 2019 at 8:58 pm](#) said:

There is a summarized poster depicting the entire seerah here if you'd like to look at it. It included The Rights of Rasoolullah (saws) upon us.

[https://ia601905.us.archive.org/18/items/TimeLineOfTheSeerahV1.0.1/time-line-of%20the-seerah\\_v1.0.1.pdf](https://ia601905.us.archive.org/18/items/TimeLineOfTheSeerahV1.0.1/time-line-of%20the-seerah_v1.0.1.pdf)

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)



[Powerful Wiyah](#) [December 16, 2019 at 12:22 pm](#) said:

Thank you, and jazakallahu khayran for the link.

Loading...

[Reply ↓](#)

Leave a Reply